# Week 3 | Real-book guide

October 26 to 30 | Characters take action

## Grade 3 | Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

## Prepare

cat, squirrel and duck figures; bowl and spoon The friends have familiar soup-making jobs. Duck wants to stir; a disagreement and his absence disrupt the group.

2026-10-26: Identify the problem: the pumpkin will not come free. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-10-27: Put two characters' attempts in story order. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-10-28: Show how the characters work together to pull the pumpkin. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-10-29: Use dialogue and character roles to act the pumpkin problem and solution. (TEKS 3.9C)

2026-10-30: Retell the problem, group action and result. (TEKS 3.7D)

## Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

## Grade 4 | Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

### Prepare

cat, squirrel and duck figures; bowl and spoon The friends have familiar soup-making jobs. Duck wants to stir; a disagreement and his absence disrupt the group.

2026-10-26: Explain why the characters' separate attempts do not solve the problem. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-10-27: Compare the bat's idea with the earlier attempts. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-10-28: Explain how the bat's idea changes the result. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-10-29: Support a message about teamwork with the pumpkin-pulling scene. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-10-30: Explain why the solution works, using the book as evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

### Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

### Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.